

The story, and how to tell it

Source material to build your own telling from - not a script to memorise

You already have the relay script - who clicks what, and when. This is the other half: **the story underneath it**. The arc, the words that carry each turn, the places to slow down, and what to do when somebody interrupts.

Read it once, then close it and tell the story in your own words. A demo that sounds recited loses the room; a demo that sounds like somebody who understands the thing keeps it. Everything here is written to be said out loud - if a sentence feels wrong in your mouth, change it. The *facts* are fixed; the phrasing is yours.

THE STORY IN ONE SENTENCE

A machine nobody was watching was costing a dealer money - and the same machine turned out to be the answer to a customer who needed one.

That is the whole arc. A problem and its solution are the **same object**. Everything else in the demo is evidence for that one reversal.

Why this is the story and not 'here are our features'

A feature tour gives judges a list to evaluate. A story gives them something to follow, and a reversal they did not see coming. **EQX1007 is flagged as waste in your first thirty seconds and is the recommendation in your last minute**. Nobody in the room will have written a demo that closes its own loop, and it is true - the availability engine really does return it, ranked, at confidence 1.00. You are not staging a coincidence; you are pointing at one.

PART ONE

The arc

Five movements. Learn these five, not the sentences - if you know the shape you can rebuild the words on the day.

	Movement	What the room should feel
1	The gap A rented machine nobody is watching	Recognition. Every one of them has lost track of something.
2	The ghost EQX1007 - on rent to nobody	A concrete number attached to a concrete object. INR 6,20,000.
3	The proof Every flag shows its working	Relief. This is not a black box asking to be trusted.
4	The reversal The ghost is the answer	Surprise. The waste we found is the machine that fills the booking.
5	The proof it moved The board changes on stage	Conviction. They watched the number change because of you.

The one thing that makes it land

Do not explain the reversal. Let them notice it. When you reach movement four, say the machine's name and stop. Someone in the room will realise it is the same machine from movement two before you tell them. That half-second of them getting there first is worth more than any sentence you could say.

PART TWO

Your opening - the first thirty seconds

You are fourth in the relay, so Mahantappa opens the whole thing. But when the laptop reaches you, you get a fresh opening of your own, and it is the most important sentence you will say. Three ways to take it - pick the one that fits the room you are actually standing in.

Option A - the plain one. Use this if the panel looks technical.

SAY

"Now the whole board. Six sentences, written by the rules - not by a language model. Every figure in them appears somewhere else on this screen and can be checked against it."

Option B - the one with a hook. Use this if the room has gone quiet.

SAY

"Everything you have just watched happened on one site. This is all twenty-seven machines - and the second line is the one that pays for this project."

Option C - the confident one. Use this only if the first three beats went well.

SAY

"So that is the customer's view, and the yard's view. This is ours. And I want to show you one line in particular, because it is the reason we built any of this."

Whichever you pick, stop talking after it. Let them read the headline. Three seconds of silence while a judge reads '9 things need you today' does more work than three sentences of you describing it.

PART THREE

The movements, with the words

Everything below is written to be spoken. Cut anything that does not sound like you.

Movement 2 - The ghost

ON SCREEN

Point at line 02 of the briefing. Do not scroll. Do not click anything yet.

SAY

"EQX1002 and EQX1007 are on rent to nobody. No site, no operator, not one engine hour."

"That is six lakh twenty thousand rupees of rental billed for nothing."

Then pause. That is your first real number and it needs a beat to land. Resist the urge to immediately explain how you calculated it - if they want that, they will ask, and the answer is one click away.

If you want one more sentence here, make it this one - it reframes the whole product from software to money:

SAY

"Nobody stole these. Nobody broke them. They were just never assigned, and the invoice kept running."

Movement 3 - The proof

This is where you earn the right to be believed. The instinct is to talk about architecture. Don't - **click something instead.**

ON SCREEN

Click the **critical** tile. The report opens with the nine flags, worth most first.

Then close it and click any single machine.

SAY

"Every flag carries the field it read, the value it saw and the threshold it crossed. A dealer who disagrees with a number can see exactly which one to argue about."

"There are eight rules and they are three different kinds - a threshold, a cross-field contradiction, and a predictive trend. R4 is the interesting one: it does not compare a number to a limit, it finds two fields that cannot both be true. A machine cannot have worked more days than it was rented for."

The strongest single sentence in your whole demo is the next one. It is the de-duplication rule, and volunteering it before anyone asks is worth more than surviving the question later:

SAY

"And one machine counts once. EQX1002 fires three separate rules - all of them waste. If we added them we would claim eleven lakh. We claim four lakh forty, because three rules firing on one rental line is three reasons, not three invoices."

Movement 4 - The reversal

ON SCREEN

Scroll to **What each site will need**. Point at the S003 row.

SAY

"A customer has asked for an excavator at S003 on the nineteenth."

"The machine the system says to send is EQX1007."

Stop here. Say nothing. Give it two full seconds. Somebody will make the connection - and if a judge says it out loud before you do, you have won the room.

Then, only then:

SAY

"That is the machine we opened on. The thing we flagged as waste is the thing that solves the request. Spotting it and fixing it turned out to be the same fact."

If they ask how the forecast works - and they will

This is the question most likely to be aimed at you, because 'forecasting' was on the brief and you did something else. Do not be defensive. **Lead with the evidence, not the excuse.**

SAY

"We do not fit a demand curve, and I will tell you why. The catalogue behind this build has eleven years of monthly volume, flat to within three percent. Fit a model to that and you get a horizontal line with a confidence interval drawn on it. That is decoration, not a forecast."

"What is knowable is mechanical. A site is working a machine type at a rate we read off that machine's own cumulative counter - never a typed-in field - and one of them is booked to leave inside the week. It will be short from the day it goes."

Then open the **why** control on any projected row and let the signals speak. The fourteen-day bar chart beside it is the series the rate was read off - the same series, not a second one drawn to agree with it.

Movement 5 - The close

You have two closes available. Use the second one if the relay ran cleanly, because it is dramatically stronger - but only if Tanish and Neerav actually completed their actions.

Close A - the safe one. Always available.

SAY

"Three kinds of money, and we never blend them. Twelve lakh sixty-six already burned. Twenty-one lakh sixty-one still billable - that one you recover with a phone call. Eighteen thousand of downtime avoided."

"We keep them apart because adding them gives you a bigger number that does not survive a question. And you would ask the question."

Close B - the one that wins. Use it if the relay worked.

ON SCREEN

Point at the headline, then at the ledger. Both have changed since you started.

SAY

"Five minutes ago this board said nine things need you today. It says eight."

"Fifteen flags are fourteen. And three lakh ninety thousand moved out of 'still billable' - because Tanish asked for a machine back and Neerav received it, in front of you."

"That is the whole claim. Insight, action, measurable outcome. Not asserted on a slide - done on the system, by three different people, in five minutes."

Then stop. Do not add a summary. Do not thank them for their time yet. Let the last number sit. The temptation to fill silence at the end of a demo has ruined more good demos than any bug.

PART FOUR

When they interrupt

They will, and it is a good sign - a panel that interrupts is engaged. Three rules: **answer the question actually asked**, **concede the limit first**, and **return to where you were**.

If they ask	Open with	Then return with
Where is the ML?	"One least-squares slope, and a language model that only phrases what the rules already computed. Everything else is a rule, on purpose."	"We have seven rows and zero recorded failures - a classifier there is fitting noise. Let me show you what we can prove instead."
What is your accuracy?	"On seven rows, nobody's accuracy figure is real."	"Ours is deterministic and auditable instead - sixty-two tests pin every rupee."

If they ask	Open with	Then return with
Is this Caterpillar's data?	"No, and we will not claim it is."	"Public catalogue, 163 brands, Caterpillar is five percent. We used it for SKUs, branches and price ratios - and we can prove that from a committed hash."
Why not a database from the start?	"We did move to one - it is on PostgreSQL now."	"It took changing one function, because only one module has ever touched storage."
This looks simple.	"It is. That was the hard part."	"Every threshold is a config key, every number traces to a field, and nothing is stored that can drift. Simple was the design goal, not the ceiling."

The one thing never to do: do not answer a question you were not asked because you prepared for it. If a judge asks about the database, do not deliver the forecasting answer. They notice, and it reads as recital rather than understanding.

PART FIVE

Delivery

Pace

You have roughly two minutes twenty for movements two through five. That is far more time than it feels like.

The most common failure is rushing. Say a number, then stop for one full second before the next sentence. Numbers need silence around them to be heard.

Your hands

Point at the screen when you say a figure - physically, with a finger. It makes the room look where you want them looking, and it stops you from scrolling while you talk, which is the single most common way a demo loses people.

What to do while somebody else is speaking

Watch the screen, not the judges. If Neerav's check-in fails you want to be the first person who knows, not the last. And a presenter watching their own product attentively is quietly persuasive.

Language to avoid

Do not say	Say instead	Why
"We tried to..."	"We built..."	Tried invites doubt you have not earned.
"It should show..."	"It shows..."	If you are unsure, look before you speak.
"Basically" / "just"	(nothing)	Both shrink whatever follows them.
"AI-powered"	"a least-squares trend"	Specific always beats impressive.
"Obviously"	(nothing)	It tells a judge who did not find it obvious that they should have.

PART SIX

The numbers you must know without looking

If you can say these from memory, you can survive any interruption and get back on track. If you cannot, you will look at the screen mid-answer and lose the room.

Number	What it is
INR 6,20,000	Two machines on rent to nobody. Your headline claim.
INR 34,45,470	Total open exposure - across three buckets that stay separate.
INR 12,66,470 / 21,61,000 / 18,000	Burned / still billable / downtime avoided.
9 things, 15 flags	What the board opens on.
71.3%	Fleet utilisation across 27 machines and 7 sites.
EQX1007	The ghost. And the answer. Confidence 1.00.
EQX1005 - 111.54 C, 4.33 days	The maintenance story. SPN 110 / FMI 0.
27 machines, 15,144 snapshots	The scale of the board.

Number	What it is
806,485 rows, 163 brands, 4.99%	The catalogue, and Caterpillar's real share of it.
62 tests	What you offer instead of an accuracy figure.

If something breaks

What happens	What you say, without stopping
A panel shows zero or spins	Check the API is alive before you say anything about the number. Never narrate a zero you have not confirmed - that is how you assert something false on stage.
The request never reaches the yard	"The scanner does exactly the same thing" - and let Neerav do it from the phone. Same event, same row.
A screen blanks	Reload it. The error boundary catches the panel, not the page - keep talking while it comes back.
The assistant says offline mode	"Ask it anyway." The deterministic path answers with no outbound call and the badge says so. That is the design, not a fault - say so and move on.
You lose your place	Go to the ledger. It is the strongest screen you have and every story you might have been telling can end there.

Before you walk in. Rehearsing the relay spends it - every check-in writes to the database and stays written. Restore, restart, and confirm the board reads **9 things need you today** and **INR 34,45,470**.

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python db/restore_baseline.py
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Last note

You know this system better than anybody in that room will after five minutes. The only way to lose is to sound like you are reciting something. Put this document down before you present, and just show them the thing you built.